

Word family: **matter / matters / mattered / mattering**

Base word: matter

Part of speech: mainly **noun** and **verb**

Related forms:

matter (n.) — 事情；問題；物質；事態；素材

matter (v.) — 重要；有關係；要緊

matters (plural n.) — 事情；事務

matter-of-fact (adj.) — 實事求是的；平淡直接的

matter-of-factly (adv.) — 平靜直接地；不帶情緒地

subject matter — 主題內容

no matter — 不管；不要緊

as a matter of fact — 事實上

for that matter — 說到那方面；其實任何同類情況也一樣

Useful expressions / extensions:

it matters

matter to someone

what matters

doesn't matter

matter a lot

matter more / less

the matter

what's the matter?

a serious matter

a private matter

a matter of

a matter of time

a matter of opinion

a matter of principle

subject matter

matter-of-fact

no matter what / who / where / how

as a matter of fact

for that matter

matter in science = 物質

Meaning in this passage

> He also said he was sorry for embarrassing me in front of the group, and that part **mattered a lot to me** because it showed that he understood exactly why I had been upset.

Here, **mattered** means:

was important or emotionally significant to me — 對我很重要；對我有分量

The speaker cared especially about that part of the apology because Kevin understood the real reason the public accusation had hurt.

中文翻譯：

而這一點對我來說**很重要**，因為那表示他真的明白我為甚麼會不開心。

So here:

matter to someone = 對某人重要、有意義、有影響

1. **matter (verb : 重要；要緊) — 重要；有關係**

This is the exact sense used in your passage.

Practice 1 — original sentence

> That part **mattered** a lot to me.

那一點對我來說**很重要**。

Practice 2

> What you say really **matters**.

你說的話真的**很重要**。

Practice 3

> Small details can **matter**.

小細節也可以**很重要**。

MCQ-ready definition:

matter = 對結果、感受或某人的判斷有重要性或影響

2. **matter to someone — 對某人重要**

Practice 1

> Your opinion **matters to me**.

你的意見對我**很重要**。

Practice 2

> Family **matters to her** more than money.

家庭對她來說比金錢**更重要**。

MCQ-ready definition:

matter to someone = 對某人的生活、感受或判斷有重要意義

3. **matter a lot / matter greatly — 非常重要**

Practice 1

> That apology **mattered a lot**.

那次道歉**非常重要**。

Practice 2

> Trust **matters greatly** in teamwork.

信任在團隊合作中**非常重要**。

MCQ-ready definition:

matter a lot/greatly = 有很大的重要性或影響

4. **matter more / less — 更重要 / 較不重要**

Practice 1

> Honesty **matters more** than appearances.

誠實比外表**更重要**。

Practice 2

> The exact wording **matters less** than the sincerity behind it.

具體措辭的重要性**不及**背後的真誠**。**

MCQ-ready definition:

matter more/less = 相比其他事情，有較高 / 較低的重要性

5. **what matters — 真正重要的事**

Practice 1

> **What matters** is that he took responsibility.

真正重要的是他承擔了責任。

Practice 2

> **What matters most** is whether the apology is sincere.

最重要的是道歉是否真誠。

MCQ-ready definition:

what matters = 最有重要性、最值得關注的事情

6. **it doesn't matter — 不要緊；沒關係**

Practice 1

> It **doesn't matter** if you're a few minutes late.

遲幾分鐘**不要緊**。

Practice 2

> “Sorry.”

> “It **doesn't matter**.”

「對不起。」

「**沒關係**。」

MCQ-ready definition:

****it doesn't matter = 某件事不重要、不造成重大問題，或不用介意****

7. ****Does it matter? — 有關係嗎？重要嗎？****

Practice 1

> ****Does it matter**** which file we use?

我們用哪個檔案****有關係嗎****？

Practice 2

> ****Does it really matter**** who speaks first?

誰先發言真的****重要嗎****？

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****Does it matter? = 詢問某件事情是否重要或會影響結果****

8. ****matter (noun : 事情；問題) — 事情；問題****

A major separate noun sense.

Practice 1

> We need to discuss an important ****matter****.

我們需要討論一件重要的****事情****。

Practice 2

> This is a private ****matter****.

這是私人****事情****。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****matter = 需要處理、討論或考慮的事情或問題****

9. ****the matter — 那件事；問題****

Practice 1

> We'll discuss **the matter** tomorrow.

我們明天再討論**這件事**。

Practice 2

> The manager is looking into **the matter**.

經理正在調查**這件事**。

MCQ-ready definition:

the matter = 已知或正在處理的特定事情 / 問題

10. **What's the matter? — 怎麼了？出了甚麼問題？**

A very common fixed expression.

Practice 1

> **What's the matter?** You look upset.

怎麼了？你看起來不開心。

Practice 2

> **What's the matter with the computer?**

電腦**出了甚麼問題**？

MCQ-ready definition:

What's the matter? = 詢問某人為甚麼不舒服 / 不開心，或某物出了甚麼問題

11. **something is the matter — 有事不對勁**

Practice 1

> I knew something was **the matter**.

我知道有些事情**不對勁**。

Practice 2

> Is anything **the matter**?

有甚麼**問題嗎**？

MCQ-ready definition:

something is the matter = 有問題、異常或令人擔心的情況

12. **a serious matter — 嚴重的事情**

Practice 1

> This is a **serious matter**.

這是一件**嚴重的事情**。

Practice 2

> The complaint became a **serious matter**.

那宗投訴變成一件**嚴重事件**。

MCQ-ready definition:

serious matter = 需要認真處理、可能有重大後果的事情

13. **a private matter — 私人事務**

Practice 1

> I'd rather not discuss it; it's a **private matter**.

我不想談，那是**私人事情**。

Practice 2

> The issue should remain a **private matter**.

這個問題應該保持為**私人事務**。

MCQ-ready definition:

private matter = 只涉及個人、不適合公開討論的事情

14. **matters** (plural : 事務) — 事務 ; 事情

Practice 1

> We discussed financial **matters**.

我們討論了財務**事務**。

Practice 2

> She handles legal **matters** for the company.

她處理公司的法律**事務**。

MCQ-ready definition:

matters = 某個範疇內需要處理或考慮的事情

15. **a matter of X** — 關乎 X ; X 的問題

A highly productive construction.

Practice 1

> It's a **matter of trust**.

這是**信任的問題**。

Practice 2

> The decision is a **matter of personal choice**.

這個決定是**個人選擇的問題**。

MCQ-ready definition:

a matter of X = 某件事情主要關乎 X 或取決於 X

16. **a matter of time** — 只是時間問題

Practice 1

> It's only a **matter of time** before they find the mistake.

他們發現錯誤**只是時間問題**。

Practice 2

> Recovery is now a **matter of time**.

現在康復**只是時間問題**。

MCQ-ready definition:

a matter of time = 某件事幾乎肯定會發生，只是不知道何時

17. **a matter of opinion — 見仁見智；意見問題**

Practice 1

> Whether the film is good is a **matter of opinion**.

電影好不好是**見仁見智**。

Practice 2

> Beauty is often a **matter of opinion**.

美很多時是**主觀判斷**。

MCQ-ready definition:

a matter of opinion = 沒有唯一客觀答案，而取決於個人看法

18. **a matter of principle — 原則問題**

Practice 1

> For her, it was a **matter of principle**.

對她來說，這是**原則問題**。

Practice 2

> He refused the money as a **matter of principle**.

他基於**原則**拒絕收錢。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****a matter of principle = 因個人或道德原則而重要的事情****

19. ****a matter of life and death — 生死攸關的事****

Practice 1

> For the patient, it was a ****matter of life and death****.

對病人而言，那是****生死攸關的事情****。

Practice 2

> It isn't a ****matter of life and death****, so stay calm.

這不是甚麼****生死攸關的大事****，冷靜一點。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****a matter of life and death = 極其嚴重、可能涉及生死的事情；亦可誇張地指非常重要****

20. ****subject matter — 主題內容；題材****

A major lexicalized compound.

Practice 1

> The ****subject matter**** is quite difficult.

這個****主題內容****相當困難。

Practice 2

> The film deals with serious ****subject matter****.

電影處理很嚴肅的****題材****。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****subject matter = 書、電影、課程、藝術作品等所處理的主要內容或題材****

21. **matter** (science : 物質) — 物質

A completely separate scientific sense.

Practice 1

> All physical objects are made of **matter**.

所有實體物件都是由**物質**構成。

Practice 2

> **Matter** can exist in different states.

物質可以以不同狀態存在。

MCQ-ready definition:

matter = 具有質量並佔據空間的物理物質

22. **solid / liquid / gaseous matter** — 固體 / 液體 / 氣態物質

Practice 1

> The sample contains organic **matter**.

樣本含有有機**物質**。

Practice 2

> The material changed from solid **matter** to liquid.

物料由固態**物質**變成液態。

MCQ-ready definition:

matter = science: 構成物體和材料的實體物質

23. **organic matter** — 有機物質

Practice 1

> The soil contains a lot of **organic matter**.

泥土含有大量**有機物質**。

Practice 2

> Dead leaves add **organic matter** to the soil.

枯葉會為土壤增加**有機質**。

MCQ-ready definition:

organic matter = 來自生物或曾經生物體的含碳物質

24. **dark matter** — 暗物質

A common scientific compound.

Practice 1

> Scientists infer the existence of **dark matter** from its gravitational effects.

科學家從其重力效應推斷**暗物質**的存在。

Practice 2

> **Dark matter** does not emit light in the ordinary way.

暗物質不會以一般方式發光。

MCQ-ready definition:

dark matter = 天文學中不能直接以光觀測、但可從重力效應推斷存在的物質

25. **matter-of-fact** — 實事求是的；平淡直接的

A useful family extension.

Practice 1

> She gave a **matter-of-fact explanation**.

她作出了一個**平靜而直接的解釋**。

Practice 2

> His tone was calm and **matter-of-fact**.

他的語氣平靜而**實事求是**。

MCQ-ready definition:

matter-of-fact = 不帶太多情緒、只是直接陳述事實的

26. **matter-of-factly** — 平靜直接地；就事論事地

Practice 1

> “I made a mistake,” he said **matter-of-factly**.

「我犯了錯。」他**平靜直接地**說。

Practice 2

> She described the incident **matter-of-factly**.

她**就事論事地**描述那件事。

MCQ-ready definition:

matter-of-factly = 用平靜、不戲劇化、直接陳述事實的方式

27. **as a matter of fact** — 事實上；其實

Practice 1

> **As a matter of fact**, I had already uploaded the file.

事實上 / 其實，我早已上傳檔案。

Practice 2

> I wasn't angry. **As a matter of fact**, I found it funny.

我沒有生氣。**其實**，我覺得很好笑。

MCQ-ready definition:

as a matter of fact = 用來補充、糾正或強調真實情況；事實上

28. **for that matter — 說到這方面；其實……也一樣**

Practice 1

> Kevin didn't check the file—or the folder properly, **for that matter**.

Kevin 沒有好好檢查檔案，**其實連資料夾也沒有好好檢查**。

Practice 2

> I don't like coffee—or tea, **for that matter**.

我不喜歡咖啡，**其實茶也不喜歡**。

MCQ-ready definition:

for that matter = 補充指出另一個相似或相關情況同樣成立

29. **no matter what — 無論甚麼；不管怎樣**

Practice 1

> I'll support you **no matter what**.

無論如何我都會支持你。

Practice 2

> **No matter what happens**, stay calm.

無論發生甚麼事，都要保持冷靜。

MCQ-ready definition:

no matter what = 無論發生甚麼或選擇甚麼，結果 / 做法都不改變

30. **no matter who / where / when / how — 無論誰 / 哪裏 / 何時 / 怎樣**

Practice 1

> **No matter who asks**, don't share the password.

****無論誰問****，都不要分享密碼。

Practice 2

> ****No matter how difficult it is****, keep trying.

****無論多困難****，都要繼續嘗試。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****no matter + wh-word = 表示某個變項無論怎樣改變，主要結果都不受影響****

31. ****matter of concern — 令人關注的事情****

Practice 1

> The delay is a ****matter of concern****.

延誤是一件****令人關注的事情****。

Practice 2

> Safety remains a serious ****matter of concern****.

安全仍是一項嚴重的****關注事項****。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****matter of concern = 令人擔心、需要注意或處理的問題****

32. ****matter at hand — 當前要處理的事情****

A useful formal phrase.

Practice 1

> Let's return to the ****matter at hand****.

我們回到****眼前要處理的事情****。

Practice 2

> We should focus on the ****matter at hand****.

我們應集中處理**當前問題**。

MCQ-ready definition:

the matter at hand = 現在正在討論或需要處理的事情

Important distinction 1: **matter as verb vs matter as noun**

Verb

> It matters.

這很重要。

Noun

> It's a serious matter.

這是一件嚴重的事情。

Same spelling, completely different grammar.

Important distinction 2: **matter to someone vs matter for something**

matter to someone

personal importance.

> It matters to me.

這對我很重要。

matter for X

less common and usually means relevance/importance for an outcome/context.

For learners, **matter to someone** is the safest high-frequency pattern for personal significance.

Important distinction 3: **matter vs mean a lot**

matter to me

重要、有分量。

mean a lot to me

對我很有意義 / 感情價值很大。

They overlap, but **mean a lot** often sounds more emotional or personal.

In your passage, both would work, but **mattered a lot to me** emphasizes importance.

Important distinction 4: **matter vs care**

matter

something has importance.

care

a person feels concern or interest.

> Your opinion matters to me.

你的意見對我很重要。

> I care about your opinion.

我在乎你的意見。

Related, but not identical.

Important distinction 5: **it doesn't matter vs I don't care**

Very important.

It doesn't matter.

沒關係 / 不要緊。

I don't care.

我不在乎。

The second can sound much colder or ruder.

Important distinction 6: **What's the matter?** vs **What's wrong?**

Very close.

What's the matter?

怎麼了？出了甚麼問題？

What's wrong?

有甚麼不對 / 怎麼了？

Both are common. **What's the matter?** can sound slightly more traditional or gentle depending on context.

Important distinction 7: **matter** vs **issue**

matter

broad affair/topic/problem.

issue

often specifically a topic for discussion or a problem.

> legal matter

法律事務

> technical issue

技術問題

They overlap but are not identical.

Important distinction 8: **matter** vs **problem**

matter

neutral; may or may not be bad.

problem

explicitly something difficult or wrong.

> a personal matter

私人事情

> a personal problem

私人問題 / 困難

Important distinction 9: **a matter of time**

This does not mean simply “about time.”

It means:

事情基本上一定會發生，只差時間

> It's a matter of time before...

= 遲早會.....

Important distinction 10: **a matter of opinion vs fact**

matter of opinion

depends on personal judgment.

matter of fact

factually true/objective.

This contrast is useful.

Important distinction 11: **matter-of-fact vs as a matter of fact**

Completely different.

matter-of-fact

adjective:

平靜、直接、實事求是

as a matter of fact

discourse phrase:

其實 / 事實上

Important distinction 12: **subject matter vs subject**

subject

topic generally.

subject matter

actual content/material dealt with in a work/course.

> subject = history

> subject matter = the specific historical content being discussed

Important distinction 13: **matter = 物質 vs material**

matter

scientific broad category of physical substance.

material

specific substance used to make something.

> matter exists in different states.

物質有不同狀態。

> wood is a building material.

木材是一種建築材料。

Important distinction 14: **matter = science vs matters = affairs**

matter uncountable:

物質

matters plural:

事情 / 事務

> physical matter

> 物質

> financial matters

> 財務事務

Context and countability matter a lot.

Important distinction 15: **no matter vs doesn't matter**

No matter + wh-word

無論.....

> No matter what happens...

無論發生甚麼.....

It doesn't matter

沒關係 / 不要緊

Different grammar.

Family-extension note

****Matter**** has several major modern branches:

1. **importance**

- * it matters
- * matter to someone
- * what matters

2. **affair / issue**

- * a serious matter
- * private matter
- * legal matters

3. **problem/condition**

- * what's the matter?
- * something is the matter

4. **fixed "a matter of" constructions**

- * matter of time
- * matter of opinion
- * matter of principle

5. **content**

- * subject matter

6. **science**

- * matter
- * organic matter
- * dark matter

7. **discourse/fixed expressions**

- * as a matter of fact
- * for that matter
- * no matter what

8. **manner**

- * matter-of-fact
- * matter-of-factly

For your passage, the exact meaning is:

matter to someone = be personally important or significant

Master comparison

Form / expression	Traditional Chinese	Core idea
-----	-----	-----
matter (verb)	重要；要緊	have importance
matter to someone	對某人重要	personal significance
matter a lot	非常重要	high importance
matter more/less	更 / 較不重要	comparative importance
what matters	真正重要的事	priority
it doesn't matter	不要緊；沒關係	unimportant
matter (noun)	事情；問題	affair
the matter	那件事 / 問題	specific issue
What's the matter?	怎麼了？	problem
serious matter	嚴重事情	important issue
private matter	私人事務	personal affair
matters	事務	affairs
a matter of X	X 的問題 / 關乎 X	central factor
matter of time	只是時間問題	inevitable eventually
matter of opinion	見仁見智	subjective
matter of principle	原則問題	values
subject matter	主題內容；題材	content
matter (science)	物質	physical substance
organic matter	有機物質	biological material
dark matter	暗物質	astronomy
matter-of-fact	實事求是的；平淡直接的	unemotional
matter-of-factly	平靜直接地	manner
as a matter of fact	事實上；其實	correction/emphasis
for that matter	說到這方面；其實.....也一樣	extension
no matter what	無論如何 / 甚麼	regardless
matter at hand	當前事情	current issue
matter of concern	關注事項	concern

For your original sentence

> He also said he was sorry for embarrassing me in front of the group, and that part ****mattered a lot to me**** because it showed that he understood exactly why I had been upset.

Here:

mattered a lot to me = 那一點對我有很大的情感重要性，因為它證明 Kevin 真正明白我受傷的原因

A natural Traditional Chinese rendering is:

> 而這一點對我來說**很重要**，因為那表示他真的明白我為甚麼會不開心。

The key distinction is:

> **matter to me** = 對我重要

> **mean a lot to me** = 對我很有意義 / 感情分量很重

> **I care about it** = 我在乎它

In this passage, **matter** is especially good because it emphasizes that this specific part of the apology carried real weight for the speaker.